Black-Box (Unauthenticated) Vulnerability Assessment

Step-by-Step Execution in Nessus (Advanced Scan)

Step 1: Create Scan

1. Login to Nessus
2. Click **Scans**
3. Click **New Scan**
4. Select **Advanced Scan**

Step 2: Basic Settings

Navigate to **Settings** → **Basic** and configure:

- **Name**
  `Black-Box VA – <Asset Name>`
- **Description**
  `Unauthenticated vulnerability assessment using Nessus Advanced Scan`
- **Targets**
  - IP address / IP range / Domain

✔️ No credentials are provided (black-box approach)

Step 3: Discovery Configuration

Go to **Settings** → **Discovery**

Host Discovery
- Turn off the “Ping the remote host”
Port Scanning

- **Port scan range**:
  - `All ports (1–65535)`

Step 4: Assessment Configuration

Go to **Settings** → **Assessment**

Enable:

- ✔️ Web application tests

Step 5: Credentials

Go to **Credentials** tab

Leave all credential fields blank

This ensures:

- Unauthenticated scanning
- External attacker simulation

Step 6: Save and Launch

1. Click **Save**
2. Click **Launch**